



#NHSWIFI2014

SURVEY OF WIFI ACCESS FOR NHS STAFF

opengpsoc
advocating open source IT in the NHS



NHS HACK DAY
GEEKS WHO LOVE THE NHS

HANDI

ehi INTELLIGENCE 

@MARCUS_BAW

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DIRECTOR, @OPENGPSOC & BAWMEDICAL

EHEALTH, DERMATOLOGY, PRISON, HOSPICE

MEDICAL DIRECTOR, @NEOVAHEALTH

PREVIOUS LIFE #1: EMERGENCY PHYSICIAN

PREVIOUS LIFE #2: ANAESTHETIST

2013

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me (Marcus Baw [change](#))

★ Excellent work DocCom, but the big problem is that we [non-consultant doctors - who provide a majority of the in- and out-of-hours staffing] STILL don't routinely have a Cisco router nailed to the roof, but they seem to be for Managerial types and possibly Consultants. Not the likes of me!

And without WiFi then no solution will help, however good. **There is a Meta-Hack here, we need to come up with an NHS Hack Day position statement to provide connectivity for staff will hold back progress, slow down care processes, and possibly even harm patients. And publish it widely.**

M

- show quoted text -

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[Show trimmed content](#)

★ Wai Keong

+ 1 for Wifi

★ Malcolm Newbury

Applaud DOCcom's use of social networking and WK MB's cry for help. Most universities now have a wifi solution called Eduroam for staff, which is a good thing.

★ Damian Roland

I entirely agree the NHS free Wifi aversion stifles innovation. I wasn't hopeful of a solution but our University IT team have been in communication with the NHS about this.

★ Jonathan Kay

Do you want a session discussing this at the London hack day? Jonathan Prof Jonathan Kay Clinical Informatics Director NHS England On 9 April 2013

★ Jon Shaw

Talking to two friends who have just returned from fellowships in Australia (Perth and Melbourne) and wifi was freely accessible throughout and clinicians were happy to use it.

★ Wai Keong

There isn't any traditional sessions at NHS Hackdays.... but I'm sure nothing is set in stone. What do you think organisers? Maybe we can have a bootcamp style session.

★ Helga Perry

We are a teaching hospital and we do not have Eduroam. Sent from my iPhone

★ Wai Keong

Martin Murphy, Clinical Director for IT NHS Wales, spoke about freewifi at the last Digital Doctor Conference as well and I think he is on a mission to make it happen.

★ Malcolm Newbury

Really?? Would be good to get idea of national coverage then - I understood it to be 100%

**IN PLACES WHERE WIFI WAS PRESENT, LOCAL CLINICIANS ASSUMED *EVERYBODY* HAD
SIMILAR LEVELS OF WIFI ACCESS**

CONVERSELY, WHERE WIFI WAS ABSENT, CLINICIANS ASSUMED *NOBODY* HAD WIFI

NOBODY ACTUALLY HAD A PICTURE OF WIFI ACCESS ACROSS THE WHOLE NHS

2013

SURVEY: Nationwide Survey of Wireless Internet Access for NHS Staff - Mozilla Firefox

bawmedical.co.uk/lime/index.php/survey

Nationwide Survey of Wireless Internet Access for NHS Staff

Please complete the following questions WiFi / Wireless Internet in your NHS workplace:

1 * Which part of the NHS do you MAINLY work in?
Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Secondary Care / Hospital
- ☐ Primary Care / GP
- ☐ Community Services
- ☐ Other:

2 * Which of the following best describes Staff access to WiFi at your usual place of NHS work? (For the purposes of this answer include only WiFi provided at/by your place of work, not WiFi from smartphone 3G tethering etc)
Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ My organisation has a free WiFi network but I do not have the password/key
- ☐ My organisation has a free WiFi network and I have the password/key to use it
- ☐ My place of work has installed its own free WiFi outside of NHS provision (eg a GP practice which has installed BT WiFi)
- ☐ A commercial provider (Wifispark, BT OpenZone or similar) WiFi service that is not free
- ☐ No WiFi - there are no WiFi networks at all
- ☐ EduRoam academic network

JOHN POPHAM - PATIENT WIFI

HOME CIVIC STORYTELLER, SOCIAL VIDEOGRAPHER, LIVE STREAMER VIDEO FOR SOCIAL GOOD BRINGING EVENTS TO THE WORLD
CONTACT ME ON TV & RADIO



Free Wifi for Hospital Patients – Progress Report

Posted on [July 15, 2011](#) by [johnpopham](#)

Well, this week I had a bit of good news. On Monday (11th July) I was at the RSA in London to present my proposal for Free Wifi for Hospital patients at the DotGovLabs Dragons' Den. The idea is outlined [here](#), if you haven't seen it before, and you can even join the [Facebook Group](#). In brief, based on family experiences, I have been campaigning for some time to get free wifi for hospital patients, as I believe it would be of massive therapeutic benefit to reduce patients' isolation by

2013 RESULTS

"WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING BEST DESCRIBES STAFF ACCESS TO WIFI AT YOUR PLACE OF NHS WORK?"

MY ORGANISATION HAS A FREE WIFI NETWORK AND I HAVE THE PASSWORD 20.30%

MY ORGANISATION HAS A FREE WIFI NETWORK BUT I DO NOT HAVE THE PASSWORD 20.18%

MY PLACE OF WORK HAS INSTALLED ITS OWN FREE WIFI OUTSIDE OF NHS PROVISION 2.63%

WIFI SERVICE THAT IS NOT FREE (EG COMMERCIAL PROVIDER) 3.76%

NO WIFI - THERE ARE NO WIFI NETWORKS AT ALL 36.22%

EDUROAM ACADEMIC NETWORK 1.38%

THE "12%"

12.16% RESPONDED 'OTHER'

A LARGE PROPORTION OF THESE WERE ALONG THE LINES OF

"There is WiFi for managers and IT staff only"

:-)

WHY DO CLINICIANS NEED WIFI ANYWAY?

(AREN'T YOU MEANT TO BE WORKING?)

KNOWLEDGE RESOURCES AT THE POINT OF CARE

ANECDOTALLY

BETTER DECISION MAKING

BASED ON BETTER EVIDENCE AND LATEST GUIDANCE

BETTER INFORMATION FOR PATIENTS



LANCET



this is why

WIKIPEDIA
The Free Encyclopedia



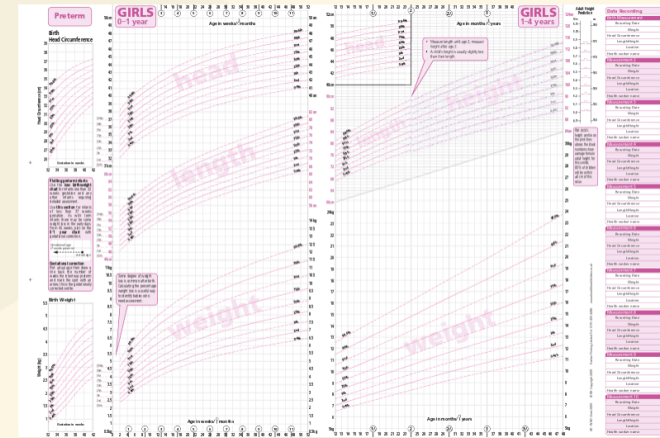
EVERNOTE



UpToDate®



QRISK®2



MOST UP-TO-DATE INFORMATION IS INTERNET BASED...
CARRYING A LOAD OF BOOKS AROUND IS INCREASINGLY
INFEASIBLE



**"WERE THERE NONE WHO WERE DISCONTENTED WITH
WHAT THEY HAVE, THE WORLD WOULD NEVER REACH
ANYTHING BETTER"**

FLORENCE NIGHTINGALE, *CASSANDRA*, 1860

**"THE REASONABLE MAN ADAPTS HIMSELF TO THE WORLD:
THE UNREASONABLE ONE PERSISTS IN TRYING TO ADAPT
THE WORLD TO HIMSELF..."**

**THEREFORE ALL PROGRESS DEPENDS ON THE
UNREASONABLE MAN"**

GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *MAXIMS FOR REVOLUTIONARIES*, 1903

Please Sir, can we have a Library?

📅 May 29, 2013 👤 Marcus Baw

The World Has Changed

Knowledge resources that were hitherto provided in books and paper journals are increasingly being accessed using Internet based methods. New sources of knowledge such as UptoDate, Map Of Medicine, NHS CKS, MedicinesComplete, Toxbase, DermNet and many others provide information in ways that could not have existed before the Internet. E-Learning, e-Portfolios and online communication between peers are vital to the flows of information we need to provide good care. Healthcare apps have approached the level of maturity and safety where they have genuine clinical utility. All these new technologies depend upon Internet connectivity, and increasingly, on mobile devices using WiFi. More importantly, *in order to secure the future development of even better technologies* (like ubiquitous electronic decision support, or a comprehensive, 'access-anywhere' cradle-to-grave health record) *we have to provide an environment in which these ideas can thrive.*

Nobody would argue that having a Library within the trust is a waste of taxpayers' money, and WiFi access is fast becoming the preferred mode of accessing information that we used to get in the library. I'm not saying libraries are obsolete, but I *am* saying that WiFi access is more than just a trifle, a toy, or a passing fad.

Tweets by @marcus_baw

WHY ISN'T HE TALKING ABOUT MOBILE ACCESS TO EHRS, TEST RESULTS, RADIOLOGY?

**IT'S A WHOLE OTHER CAN OF WORMS
ISSUES WITH INTERFACING WITH EHRS**

VENDOR-SPECIFIC COMPLICATIONS & OBSTINACY

INFORMATION GOVERNANCE, SECURITY, DEVICE

LOCKDOWN AUTHENTICATION

MEDICAL SCHOOL IPADS

NUMEROUS MEDICAL SCHOOLS (MANCHESTER, LEICESTER, DARTMOUTH) ARE PROVIDING
IPADS TO ALL MEDICAL STUDENTS [HTTP://BIT.LY/1WUORBH](http://bit.ly/1WUORBH)

2013 SURVEY IMPACT

TURNS OUT...

HSCIC & NHS ENGLAND DON'T ACTUALLY HAVE ANY OF THIS INFORMATION

BUT THEY WERE INTERESTED TO HEAR ABOUT IT

**PRESENTED FINDINGS TO JONATHAN KAY, CLINICAL INFORMATICS DIRECTOR, NHS
ENGLAND**

PRESENTED LAST YEAR AT SKUNKWORKS, NHS ENGLAND

2014

REPEATED THE SURVEY

SUPPORTED BY E-HEALTH INSIDER

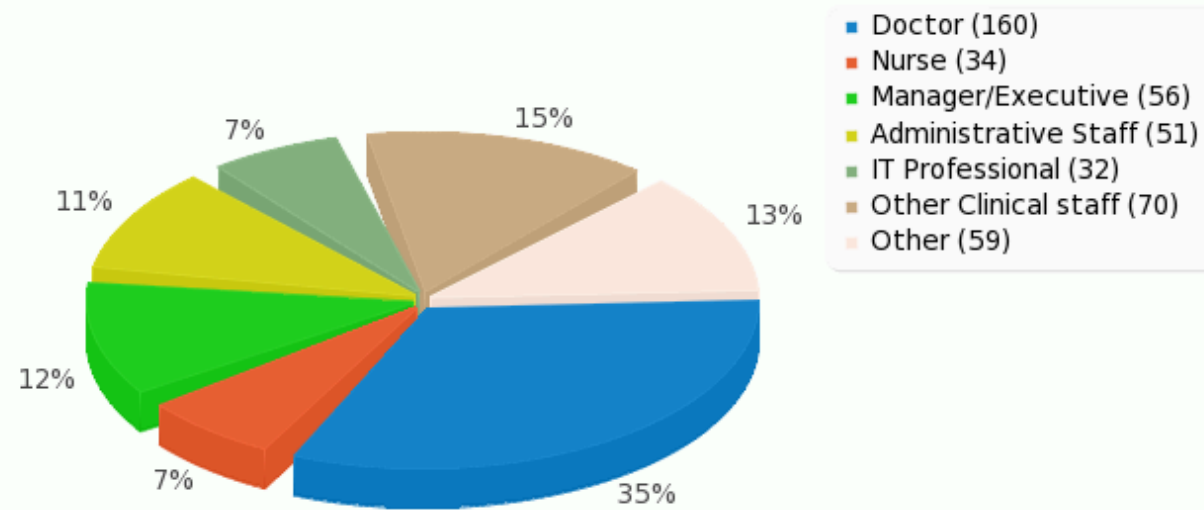
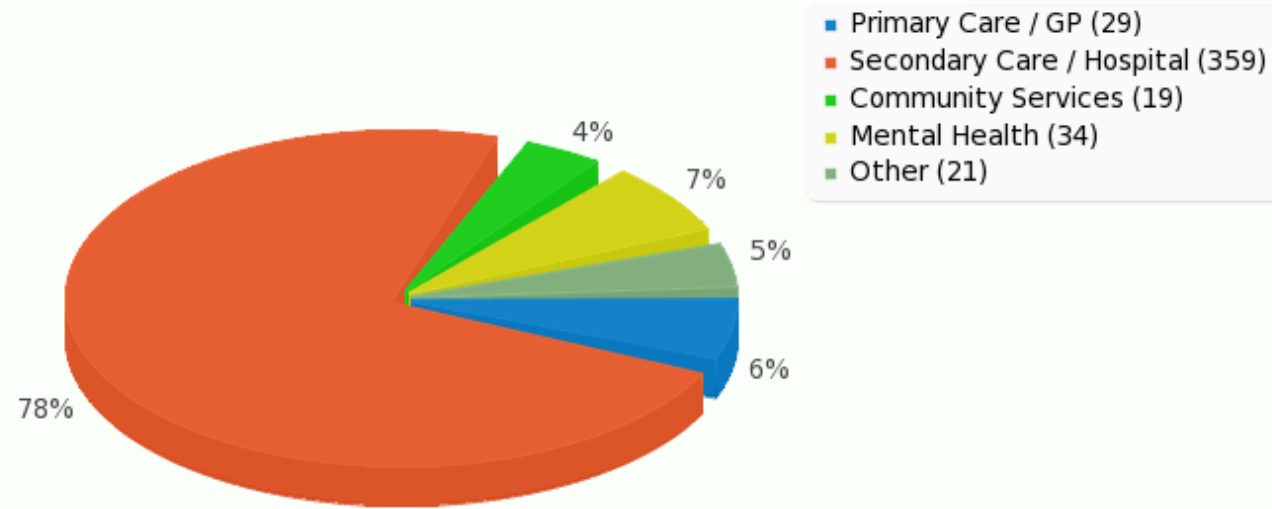
SAME BASIC IDEA, QUESTIONS TWEAKED SLIGHTLY

2014

LIMESURVEY-POWERED (OPEN SOURCE SELF HOSTED SURVEY ENGINE)

SEPT-OCT 2014 ABOUT 500 RESPONDENTS

SURVEY DESIGN HAD TO COMPROMISE BETWEEN SIMPLICITY AND PERFECTION OF DATA



CAN YOU ACCESS WIFI IN YOUR PLACE OF NHS WORK?

WIFI

2014 YES 51 24%

'YESWIFI' SUBGROUP

I CAN CONNECT TO WIFI WITH MY OWN DEVICE (BYOD) 61.13%

I CAN CONNECT TO WIFI WITH A WORK-PROVIDED DEVICE 53.04%

WIFI REQUIRES LOGIN ON A WEB PAGE AFTER DEVICE CONNECTS TO WIFI NETWORK 42.91%

I HAVE ACCESS TO EDUROAM, THE ACADEMIC WIFI NETWORK 5.67%

WIFI IS PROVIDED BY A COMMERCIAL SERVICE 22.67%

WIFI ACCESS IS FREE 77.33%

WIFI ACCESS WORKS IN MOST AREAS OF MY WORKPLACE THAT I NEED IT TO 52.63%

'NOWIFI' SUBGROUP

**WIFI ACCESS IS ONLY FOR WORK DEVICES AND I HAVEN'T BEEN PROVIDED WITH ONE
52.36%**

**WIFI ISN'T REQUIRED - INTERNET AND CLINICAL RECORD ACCESS VIA DESKTOP PCS IS
SUFFICIENT 10.85%**

THERE ARE NO WIFI NETWORKS AT ALL 28.77%

THERE IS A GOOD MOBILE DATA SIGNAL (IE 3G, 4G) IN MY PLACE OF WORK 11.79%

SUMMARY

DEFINITE IMPROVEMENT OVER LAST YEAR'S RESULTS

STILL ONLY 50% OF CLINICAL STAFF HAVE ACCESS THOUGH

**STILL A LOT OF COMMENTS THAT WIFI IS AVAILABLE BUT ONLY FOR IT STAFF/MANAGERS
(AND IN ONE COMMENT THE CLEANERS - ?HYPERBOLE) BUT NOT CLINICAL STAFF.**

EVEN WHERE WIFI IS PRESENT, 30% IS NON-FREE

AND ONLY 50% REPORTED IT WAS EVERYWHERE IT IS NEEDED

MY MESSAGES

WIFI IS NOT A TOY, CLINICIANS NEED IT TO WORK SMARTER AND SAFER

NOT PROVIDING WIFI FOR YOUR CLINICIANS IS LIKE HAVING NO HOSPITAL LIBRARY

ALLOW BYOD. YOU *TRUST* CLINICIANS TO TREAT PATIENTS DON'T YOU?

IF YOU WANT TO PROVIDE TRUST HARDWARE, FINE, JUST DON'T MAKE THIS A ROADBLOCK

LANDING PAGE LOGINS *SIGNIFICANTLY* REDUCE USABILITY

2015?

WILL I NEED TO RUN THIS SURVEY AGAIN?

****PREPARES TO GRIND AXES****

SEMI-ARBITRARY AND COUNTERPRODUCTIVE WEB FILTERS?

IT HARDWARE UNDERPOWERED FOR MODERN USES?

THE SURVEY IS STILL LIVE, AT:

[BIT.LY/NHSWiFi2014](https://bit.ly/NHSWiFi2014)

LINKS & THANKS

[WWW.OPENGPSOC.ORG](http://www.opengpsoc.org)

[WWW.HANDIHEALTH.ORG](http://www.handihealth.org)

[WWW.NHSHACKDAY.ORG](http://www.nhshackday.org)

DISCUSSION